According to Juzjani, in the same year "the armies of Ghur and Ghazna were prepared" for Herat: that is, possibly as reciprocation for support in the Ghazna victory, Ghiyath al-Din called upon his younger brother to join in the campaign. Their joint efforts were again successful, and the Shansabani forces took Herat from Baha' al-Tughril al-Sanjari, one of Sultan Sanjar's residual deputies. The occupation of this renowned city of eastern Khurasan also led to the submission of the *malik*s of Sistan, "who sent envoys and submitted themselves in unanimous service to the king [*padshah*, i.e., Ghiyath al-Din]."[74]

At this juncture, it is worthwhile considering the consequences of these victories upon the Shansabanis' changing military manpower. Nomadic contingents had been substantial within 'Ala' al-Din Husain's forces when he confronted Sanjar at Nab in AH 547/1152–1153 CE, and their defection was at least partially responsible for the Shansabanis' defeat. But with the victory at Ghazna, the Shansabanis surely gained access to Khurasan's *ghulam* economy, fueled by the large-scale demand for Turkic youths among all the ruling powers of the Persianate world; the old Yamini capital had been one of the principal regional markets for this specialized military labor.[75] Although the city's decade-long occupation by the Oghüz could have reduced the supply of *ghulam*s from the Eurasian steppe, circumstantial evidence would indicate that the flow was not altogether interrupted: after all, Mu'izz al-Din's eastward campaigns only grew in number and distance *after* the Ghazna victory (cf. below), ultimately resulting in the Shansabanis' foothold in the north Indian *duab* thanks in large part to the military skills and leadership of the well-known Mu'izzi *ghulam*s Qutb al-Din Aibeg,[76] Taj al-Din Yildiz, and Baha' al-Din Tughril (cf. Volume II).

The Herat victory – only about a year after that of Ghazna – would certainly have provided even greater access to the valuable military resource of *ghulam*s for westward campaigns, though these appear to have been less successful than their eastward counterparts. Although Shansabani coinage was minted at Marv (captured AH 597/1201 CE), and at Astarabad in Gurgan (possibly AH 600/1204 CE), it is curious that no issues are known from the pre-eminent Khurasani emporium of Nishapur, where a Shansabani victory over the Khwarazm-shahi forces in AH 597/1201 CE led to the city's occupation until AH 601/1205 CE. Moreover, with the possible exception of the tomb of the last Ghazna Shansabani ruler 'Ala' al-Din Muhammad (d. AH 602/1206 CE) west of Nishapur at Bistam (Figure 1.17),[77] there is no known Shansabani architectural patronage beyond Herat.

In the east, the last of the Yamini–Ghaznavids had essentially been relegated to Lahore as of the AH 570s/1170s CE, and Mu'izz al-Din seemed to be filling the politico-military vacuum left in their wake: in AH 574/1178 CE, he undertook his first – albeit unsuccessful – long-distance campaign, probably through Kurraman (west of Peshawar) and again *via* Multan-Uchh,